



Signs your dog may be suffering from a storm or noise phobia

- It is common for dogs to be scared of bad weather, storms, fireworks, heavy machinery or loud sudden noises.
- If your dog is outside, he may try to get inside. Dogs will sometimes damage doors or windows when they panic to get inside.
- Your dog may escape your property when they panic
- If your dog is inside, they may try to hide. Dogs will sometimes damage property when they are trying to find a place to hide and begin panicking. They may chew up furniture or scratch and claw at doors or windows.
- Dogs may injure themselves when they are looking to escape.
- If you are with your dog, they may try to sit with you and lean onto you.
- They often shake, tremble and pant rapidly.
- They often whine, bark or howl.
- They can become so scared they vomit, urinate or have diarrhoea.
- Their eyes look wide (you can see the whites) and their pupils look very big.
- Dogs will attempt to escape the property to run away from the storm or loud noise.

How to help a dog with noise or storm phobias

Dogs feel better if they can come inside the house and be comforted by their family. Close all the windows and shut the curtains to block out any light flashes.

Calming music, such as Through a Dog's Ear, can help some dogs to relax and mask any loud sudden noises in the environment.

There is a widespread myth that you should not comfort dogs when they are scared. This has been scientifically proven to be untrue. Dogs need to feel safe and secure. When they are scared they need to be comforted by their guardians.





Dogs should not be punished for their fear of storms or loud noises. In fact, punishing them for being scared can actually make their fear worse. Do not become upset or angry with your dog, instead work to make them feel safe.

Some dogs prefer to hide and be left alone. Let your dog find a hiding spot for them to be comfortable in. Most dogs feel safe under a table or desk, you can drape a blanket over the top to give the dog an extra safe haven.

Crate training can help dogs with storm and noise phobias. Crates can be used as safe dens for dogs to use and relax in. They can be filled with comfortable warm bedding and covered with a blanket inside the home.

If your pet is scared during storms, fireworks or loud noises try offering them new toys. If your dog likes to tear up soft toys give them a new toy to rip during these scary events.

See if you can play a game that your dog loves during the storm or fireworks.

There are 'thunder shirts' that can be worn to help your dog calm down. They do not work on all dogs and your dog should not be left alone while wearing one. Please always follow the manufacturer's directions.

If your dog is taking longer than 30 minutes to recover from a storm or loud noise you should seek help from your veterinarian.

Some dogs may have severe phobias. They struggle to calm down after a storm or loud sounds. These dogs should be seen by their regular veterinarian and possibly referred to a Veterinary Behaviourist for a medical treatment plan.

Where to find more help and advice

<https://www.rspcasa.org.au/services/dog-services/dog-training/>





RSPCA SA offers dog training classes and one on one training all over Adelaide. Go to our dog training page and register your interest. Our one on one trainers can help you manage your dog's behaviour with up to date scientifically effective methods.

<https://www.rspcasa.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2019/01/FF-Trainers-List-Update-Jan-2019.pdf>

RSPCA SA have a list of qualified force free trainers all over Adelaide. They offer many different services such as group classes and in home consultations.

This list also include a list of Veterinary Behaviourists that can help you with your pet's medical needs.

What to do if you can no longer care for your pet

If at any time during your pet's life you can no longer care for them, please surrender them into our care.

